WELCOME · The Holy Earth Foundation

Welcome to The Holy Earth Foundation

Seven stops from "I have no GitHub account" to "I read, I answer, and my helper reads with me"

For a newcomer, and for the AI helper beside them. Every slide points at a real page; the deck only shows the order to open them in. Nothing here asks you to type a command.

Who this is for, and how to read it

- **You**, if you have just been invited to The Holy Earth Foundation, or are about to be.
- **Your helper** (Claude, ChatGPT, Codex, Littlebird, any of them), which reads the same pages you do, never more than you can.
- Every slide points at a real page. The deck shows the **order**; the pages hold the detail.

> Read it once top to bottom. After that, jump to the stop you need. Everything The Holy Earth Foundation writes wears these four shades, so you can tell whose page it is before you read a word.

The path at a glance

	Stop	What you leave with
1	Your first hour	your own account, two-factor sign-in, the invitation accepted
2	Five words	repository, branch, pull request, issue, merge
3	Proposals	how an idea asks for a decision, and where yours is waiting
4	Procedures	how an approved thing is done, step by step
5	The reading room, and your helper	where members read, and how a helper reads with you
6	How a change travels	rehearsal, Promote, live, the public twin
7	How to answer	the right door for a yes, a question or a request

1 Your first hour

	Step	You should see
	Sign up at `github.com/signup` with **your own** email; **you type your own password**	your empty dashboard
	Turn on two-factor sign-in; keep the recovery codes with important papers	"Two-factor authentication is enabled"
	Send your **username** (never the password) to a steward or Kenney, wherever you already talk with the foundation	an invitation by email, or on the bell icon
	Click **Join**	The Holy Earth Foundation under your profile's Organizations

> Nobody needs your password or a sign-in code: not a steward, not a friend, not a helper. Invitations go to your username.

The full procedure is **SOP-COM-001 "New to GitHub: your first hour"**: members read it today in the reading room; visitors in `ops-standard-operating-procedures-public` once its first sync runs.

2 Five words, and you can find your way

	Word	Means
	Repository	a folder that remembers every change and who made it
	Branch	one line of that history: `main` is the live copy, `preview` the rehearsal
	Pull request	a change asking to move from one branch to another, with a place to comment
	Issue	a conversation thread: the easiest way to ask or answer
	Merge	accepting a pull request so the change lands; a person with the role does it

You never need to type a branch command. You read, you comment, and you say yes or no.

3 Proposals: *should we?*

1. **TL;DR**: five lines, the only part you have to read.
2. **What is offered**: how things are today, beside what is proposed.
3. **Decisions log**: what was chosen, when, and by whom. Yours stay blank until you choose.
4. **Asks**: usually none, sometimes one.
5. **Sources, and what could not be confirmed**: folded away, never hidden.

Each proposal is a **PDF for your eyes** and the **markdown it was made from** for your helper's. Start with **000 Start here**: members in `proposals`, visitors in the public room.

4 Procedures: *this is how we do it now*

- Named `SOP-<Department>-<ID>-<name>`: `SOP-OPS-001` is the first operations procedure.
- A **draft** until the officers tag an approved version; the tag is the approval.
- Each one opens with a badge row in **The Holy Earth Foundation's colour**, puts an icon beside each idea and a diagram where a picture explains the mechanism, and is also a PDF.

Start with	Says
SOP-COM-001	your first hour (stop 1, in full)
SOP-OPS-001	how a change travels (stop 6, in full)
SOP-GOV-002	how GitHub collaboration works here: teams, issues, pull requests, Pages

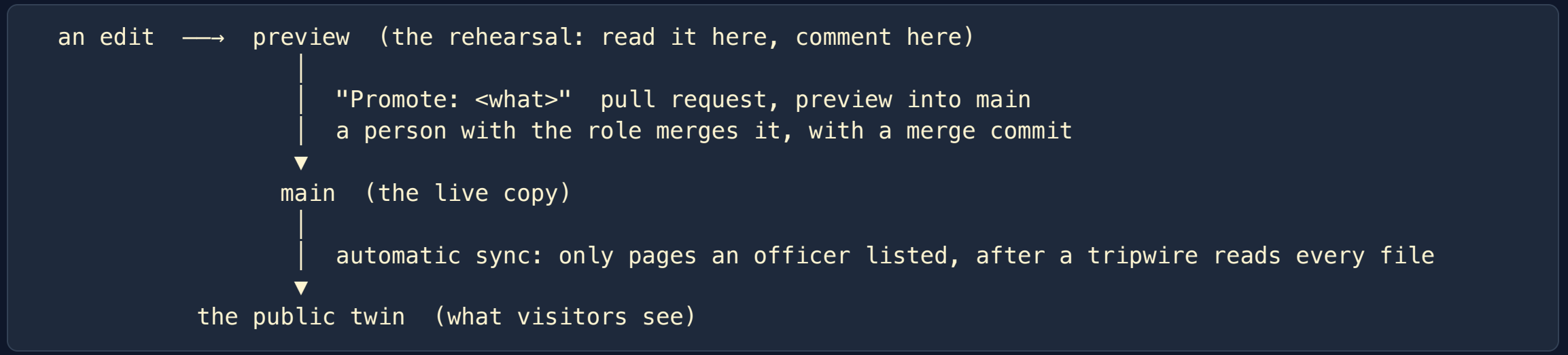
The procedures visitors may read: `ops-standard-operating-procedures-public`.

5 The reading room, and your helper

- The reading room gathers what members read: proposals, procedures and decks, each a page and a PDF. Open `theholyearthfoundation/reading-room` while signed in.
- A **404** there means "not yet in the readers team" or "signed out", not "broken": ask a steward or Kenney, wherever you already talk with the foundation.
- What is ready for visitors also appears in the **public room**, which links back to this one.
- **Your helper** reads the same pages once you connect it with your permission, never more than you can. Point it at the markdown, not the PDF.

> A good first question for your helper: "*Read 000 Start here and tell me, in five lines, what is waiting for my answer.*"

6 How a change travels



- **Merge, never squash**, so every author's name and every helper's signature survives.
- **A helper opens the Promote; a person merges it.** Helpers never merge.
- A page that is not listed never leaves the private repository, on any branch.

7 How to answer

You want to…	Do this
say yes, no, or "not yet" to a proposal	open an **issue** titled with its number, or ask a steward to note it in the decisions log
comment on a change before it goes live	comment on the **Promote** pull request
ask about a procedure	open an issue in the procedures repository, naming the SOP
let your helper draft an answer	let it draft; **you** read it and post it under your name
get access, or more of it	ask a steward or Kenney, wherever you already talk with the foundation

> There is no wrong door. A question in the wrong place gets moved, not lost.

Where to start

You are…	Open
brand new to GitHub	**SOP-COM-001** in `ops-standard-operating-procedures-public`
a member with an account	**000 Start here** in `theholyearthfoundation/proposals`
looking for what to read	the reading room: `theholyearthfoundation/reading-room`
an AI helper	the repository's `AGENTS.md`, then **SOP-OPS-002** (helpers open pull requests; people merge)
stuck anywhere	a steward or Kenney, wherever you already talk with the foundation

Questions go where the work is: an issue on the repository, or a comment on the Promote.